

Getting Together

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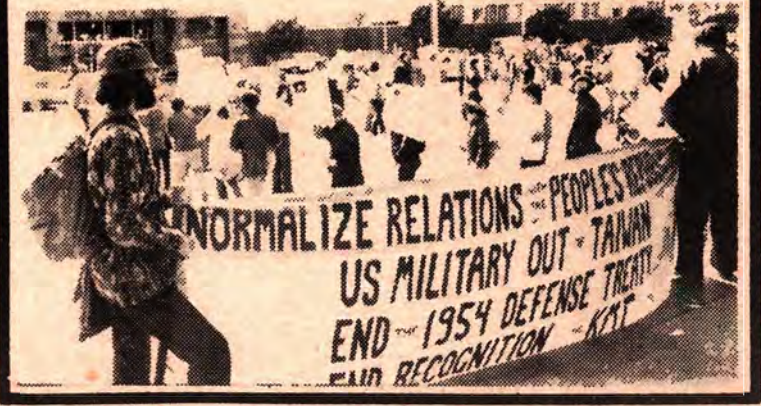
Countries Want Independence, Nations Want Liberation, People Want Revolution

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Normalize U.S.-China relations
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February 28, 1947

Commemorate the Taiwan Uprising

February 28 marks the historic signing of the Joint Sino-US Shanghai Communique. This date also marks another important event, the anniversary of the heroic Taiwan Uprising of 1947.

Thirty one years ago, on February 28, the masses all across China's Taiwan Province rose in armed rebellion against the reactionary rule of the Chiang regime. The masses demonstrated their outrage at the brutality of the Chiang clique's rule. The reactionary Kuomintang (KMT) foisted upon the people of Taiwan Province higher taxes, inflation, political repression, and overall misery. As the socialist revolution was nearing complete victory, the masses were outraged at the Chiang clique's willingness to sell out China's national interest by collaborating with the U.S. imperialists over the future of Taiwan.

The actual uprising began when an elderly woman vendor was murdered by Chiang's troops. What began as a massive riot soon escalated to organized armed insurrection against the reactionary Chiang clique. In some regions, Chiang's military and administrative offices were completely occupied by the masses. Many towns and cities in the province were liberated within just a few days. The uprising quickly gained the support of the masses throughout China, including the Central Committee of the Chinese Communist Party.

Chiang, fearing he would lose

the entire province, launched a most bloody counter offensive against the masses. Thousands were arrested and massacred by the Chiang puppet troops. But however, to this day, the uprising remains a great inspiration to the Taiwan masses' continuing struggle against the Chiang regime and against imperialism.

The masses of Taiwan Province are still oppressed by the Chiang regime and imperialist powers. Several months ago, thousands of people in the Taoyuan County town of Chungli, 50 miles from Taipei, demonstrated in the streets to protest the Chiang clique's corrupt elections. They attacked the police station and hurled rocks through the windows, and set fire to several police cars.

In the struggle, many people were injured and a nineteen year old youth was shot in the head by a policeman. Since the protests, the Chiang clique has increased its brutal repression of the masses through political arrests and increased surveillance.

These recent demonstrations show, however, that the militant spirit of the Taiwan Uprising and the masses' hatred of the reactionary Chiang clique and foreign imperialists is a powerful force. In commemorating the 1947 Taiwan Uprising, it is important to also demand the immediate normalization of U.S.-China relations and an end to U.S. recognition of the illegal Chiang regime.

San Francisco and Boston struggles

Masses protest attacks on 3rd world community schools



San Francisco school children protest school "redesign" plan, January 1978 (Getting Together photo)

Mass struggles are breaking out in Boston and San Francisco against the new government plans for reorganization of the public schools. The plans bear similarity in that both claim to be geared toward achieving "racial balance" and improved education in the schools. However, parents, students and teachers in Black, Latino and Asian communities in both cities have loudly protested the plans as discriminatory and unjust to Third World people.

In San Francisco, public hearings around the schools "redesign plan" were held before packed

audiences of angry people. At one hearing at Horace Mann Jr High in the Latino Mission District, crowds of people prevented the superintendent of schools from cutting the meeting short and leaving the room, forcing him to continue the hearing.

Thus and other actions show that the masses will not allow the new school plans to go through.

Boston Roxbury plan attacks Blacks

The Boston school department is proposing to close Roxbury High School. Roxbury High is small and

old, and lacks modern equipment and various programs, but it is the only high school in Boston's Black community, and the masses are defending it for this reason.

The masses are also protesting because the closing of Roxbury High will mean the transfer of many Black students to Charlestown High in a white community at the opposite end of the district. Blacks would be bused across town under Boston's forced busing program, increasing the dispersal of Black students. It would also make it harder for the Black masses to fight for special school programs, and would make the public school system even less accountable to the demands of the Black community.

This is not the first time that Roxbury High and the Black community have been under attack by the school system. A few years ago, plans were made to replace Roxbury High with a new facility, Madison Park High School, which many Blacks looked forward to attending. But when Madison Park opened in September 1977, it was changed into a "magnet school," with specialized programs which draw students citywide. By requiring magnet school enrollment to reflect the racial make up of the whole city, most Blacks from Roxbury were automatically excluded.

Now the current plan to close Roxbury High has met with im-

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Land claims undermined

Court rules Wampanoags not a tribe

Mashpee, Mass. — On January 6, 1978, a Federal jury in Boston decided that the Wampanoag Indians of Mashpee, Massachusetts — a small Cape Cod town — were not a tribe. The judge in the case had ruled earlier that the question of whether or not the Wampanoags constituted a tribe was the key issue in a land claim suit filed by the Native Americans.

This land claim suit, filed over a year ago in U.S. District Court, demands the return of 11,000 acres valued at \$30 million. The suit is based on a law dating back to 1790 that prohibits the transfer of Indian lands without congressional approval. Most of the land under suit is currently owned by real estate developers like the New Seabury Corp., which alone owns 1760 acres. The Native Americans are up against these capitalists and their government



Ellsworth Oakley, Wampanoag chief

and courts in a battle over land, natural resources, and national rights.

Similar suits have been filed by Native Americans in other parts

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The coal miners of Appalachia and the Midwest are steadily advancing their strike activities in spite of intense repression by the capitalist class. The strike by 180,000 members of the United Mine Workers (UMW) against the Bituminous Coal Operators Association (BCOA) is entering its third month and the miners are prepared to stay out as long as it takes to settle a decent contract. The miners realized, from the outset, that they could win their demands only by sustaining a long and bitter strike. (See *Getting Together*, January 1978, Vol IX, No 1).

Strike having big impact

Previous to the strike, the capitalist power companies, among others, stockpiled large quantities of coal with the hopes of by passing the effects of a winter strike. But the impact of the strike is already being felt, as coal production dropped from 14.8 million tons the week before the strike, to the present 5.7 million tons per week. The extremely severe winter storms in the Midwest and East Coast have contri-

buted to the dwindling of stockpiles and the utility companies are now getting worried.

The bourgeois press has tried to downplay the effects of the strike. Recently, the press has been releasing reports almost daily, saying that there has been a "breakthrough" in the contract negotiations and that a "settlement may be reached soon." However, even if the labor bureaucrats, headed by UMW President Arnold Miller, reach a settlement with the BCOA, the strikers have expressed that they will not accept anything

which falls short of a healthy raise, a 100% restoration of their medical and pension funds, increased health benefits, nor will they accept any agreement which will outlaw their right to strike.

Under the expired contract, coal miners' medical and pension benefits were paid into a trust fund based on 80 cents per ton of coal produced and not on the actual needs of the miners. But the coal companies did not even put this money into the trust fund, and before the strike began, they

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